

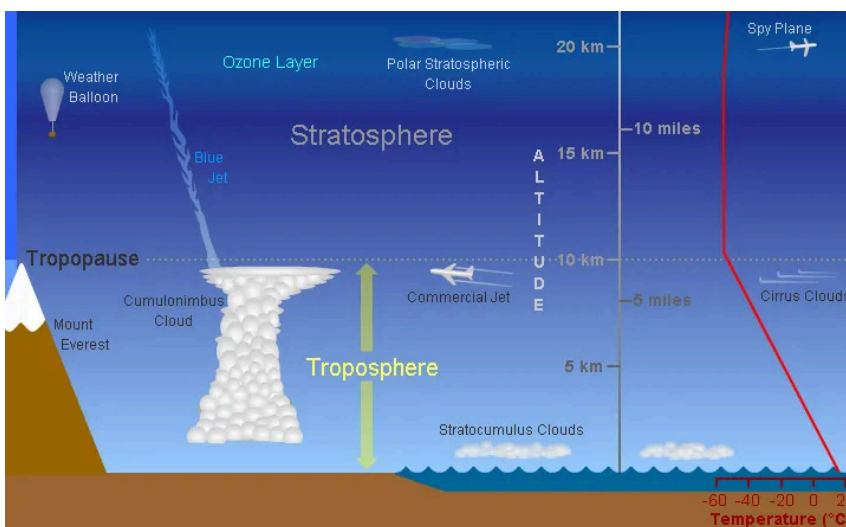


NSF NCAR Mesa Lab road lane closures Aug. 24-25 – Expect delays and no pedestrian or bicycle access. [VIEW MORE INFORMATION.](#)

[CLOSE](#)

The Troposphere

The troposphere is the lowest [layer of Earth's atmosphere](#). Most of the mass (about 75–80%) of the atmosphere is in the troposphere. Most types of clouds are found in the troposphere, and almost all [weather](#) occurs within this layer. The troposphere is by far the wettest layer of the atmosphere (all of the other layers contain very little moisture).



This diagram shows some of the features of the



LAYERS OF
EARTH'S
ATMOSPHERE



information about you. When using our website, you may encounter embedded content, such as YouTube videos and other social media links, that use their own cookies. To learn more about third-party cookies on this website, and to set your cookie preferences, click [here](#).

ACKNOWLEDGE

of 30,000 feet) near the equator, and as low as 7 km (4 miles or 23,000 feet) over the poles in winter.

Air is warmest at the bottom of the troposphere near ground level. Air gets colder as one rises through the troposphere. That's why the peaks of tall mountains can be snow-covered even in the summertime.

Air pressure and the density of the air also decrease as altitude increases. Jet aircraft often fly just above the tropopause, which is the boundary between the troposphere and the more stable [stratosphere](#). Because of the decrease in air pressure with height, the cabins of these high-flying jet aircraft are pressurized.

How likely are you to recommend this page to a friend? *

UCAR uses cookies to make our website function;
however, UCAR cookies do not collect personal

information about you. When using our website, you may encounter embedded content, such as YouTube videos and other social media links, that use their own cookies. To learn more about third-party cookies on this website, and to set your cookie preferences, click



This material is based upon work supported by the NSF National Center for Atmospheric Research, a major facility sponsored by the U.S. National Science Foundation and managed by the University Corporation for Atmospheric Research. Any opinions, findings and conclusions or recommendations expressed in this material do not necessarily reflect the views of the [U.S. National Science Foundation](#).

UCAR uses cookies to make our website function;
however, UCAR cookies do not collect personal